

L^AT_EX for the Humanities

A short introduction

Dr. Xander Vertegaal

Utrecht University Centre for Digital Humanities

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- $\text{\LaTeX}$ commands
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3 III: Where to go from here

- Use cases for $\text{\LaTeX}$
- Troubleshooting
- AI and $\text{\LaTeX}$

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- AI and $\text{\LaTeX}$

What is $\text{\LaTeX}$?

- $\text{\TeX}$ (Donald Knuth, 1978)
- Name < Greek τέχνη *techne* ('art', 'craft')

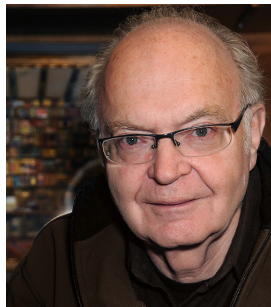
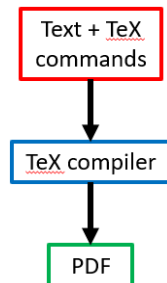


Figure: Donald Knuth

What is $\text{\LaTeX}$?

- $\text{\TeX}$ (Donald Knuth, 1978)
- Name < Greek τέχνη *techne* ('art', 'craft')
- A *compiler* turns your text and commands into a PDF.



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- $\text{\TeX}$ (Donald Knuth, 1978)
- Name < Greek τέχνη *techne* ('art', 'craft')
- A *compiler* turns your text and commands into a PDF.
- Original $\text{\TeX}$ is rather complicated.

Starting a new section in $\text{\TeX}$:

```
\newcount\sectionnumber
\global\advance\sectionnumber by 1
\bigskip\noindent
{\bf \the\sectionnumber.\ My section}\par
\medskip
```

What is $\text{\LaTeX}$?

- $\text{\TeX}$ (Donald Knuth, 1978)
- Name < Greek τέχνη *techne* ('art', 'craft')
- A *compiler* turns your text and commands into a PDF.
- Original $\text{\TeX}$ is rather complicated.
- $\text{\LaTeX}$ (Leslie Lamport, 1984)
- Macro package for $\text{\TeX}$



Figure: Leslie Lamport

Starting a new section in $\text{\LaTeX}$:

```
\section{My section}
```

Core philosophy

LaTeX core philosophy

LaTeX

- is free and open-source software

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- provides professional levels of typesetting control

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L^AT_EX core philosophy

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Still, there is quite a learning curve.

Core philosophy

L^AT_EX core philosophy

L^AT_EX

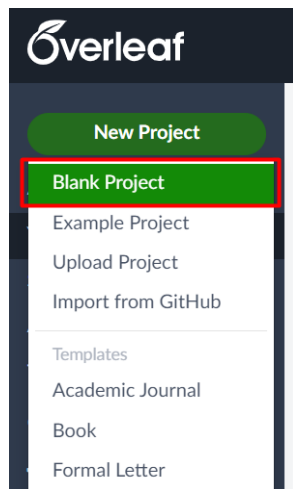
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- separates content from layout ('just start typing')

Still, there is quite a learning curve.

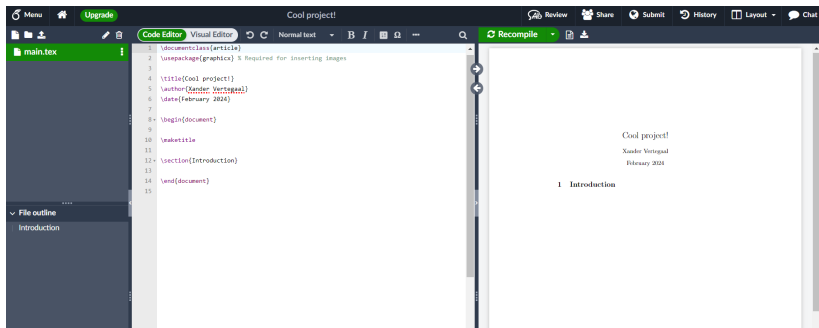
That is what this tutorial is for.

Creating a new document

- Visit Overleaf
- Click on “Create a new project”
- Select “Blank Project”
- Come up with a catchy title
- Hit ‘Create’!



Overleaf



L^AT_EX commands

Simple commands (also called **switches**):

```
\maketitle  
\LaTeX  
\centering
```

L^AT_EX commands

Simple commands (also called **switches**):

```
\maketitle
```

```
\LaTeX
```

```
\centering
```

backslash + command name

L^AT_EX commands

Commands with **mandatory** arguments:

```
\section{Introduction}  
\author{Albert Einstein}
```

L^AT_EX commands

Commands with **mandatory** arguments:

```
\section{Introduction}  
\author{Albert Einstein}
```

backslash + command name + mandatory argument

L^AT_EX commands

Commands with **optional** arguments:

```
\documentclass[12pt]{article}
```

L^AT_EX commands

Commands with **optional** arguments:

```
\documentclass[12pt]{article}
```

backslash + command name + optional argument + mandatory
argument

L^AT_EX commands

Environments:

```
\begin{center}
```

...

```
\end{center}
```

L^AT_EX commands

Environments:

```
\begin{center}
```

...

```
\end{center}
```

backslash + begin / end + environment name

Commands – exercise

Exercise

(NB: write your answers in the `document` environment.)

- Write ‘Hello, $\text{\LaTeX}$!’ in the Introduction section.
- Add a subsection in the Introduction section using the `\subsection{...}` command and call it ‘Background’.
- Use the `abstract` *environment* to put an abstract before the Introduction section.

Document structure

There are two required commands in a $\text{\LaTeX}$ document:

- ❶ the `\documentclass{...}` command;
 - `article`: generic short(er) documents
 - `beamer`: for PPT-like presentations
 - `book`: full books
 - `letter`: letters
 - `report`: long articles with chapters
- ❷ a `\begin{document}...\end{document}` environment with some text.

Note

Document classes enable different layouts and commands. The `letter` class, for example, has a `\signature{...}` and a `\closing{...}` command.

Document structure

The document environment encapsulates the **document body**.

Everything before that is called the **preamble**.

This is where you do all of your initial configuration.

Type style (3.1)

Effect	Command	Switch/Environment
Upright shape	<code>\textup{...}</code>	<code>\upshape</code>
<i>Italic shape</i>	<code>\textit{...}</code>	<code>\itshape</code>
<i>Slanted shape</i>	<code>\textsl{...}</code>	<code>\slshape</code>
SMALL CAPS SHAPE	<code>\textsc{...}</code>	<code>\scshape</code>
Medium series	<code>\textmd{...}</code>	<code>\mdseries</code>
Bold series	<code>\textbf{...}</code>	<code>\bfseries</code>
Roman family	<code>\textrm{...}</code>	<code>\rmfamily</code>
Typewriter family	<code>\texttt{...}</code>	<code>\ttfamily</code>
Sans serif family	<code>\textsf{...}</code>	<code>\sffamily</code>

Table: Type styles with a sample text.

Typestyle (3.1)

Usage:

This is upright. *This is italic.* This is upright again.

① With a **regular command**:

This is upright. `\textit{This is italic.}` This is upright again.

Typestyle (3.1)

Usage:

This is upright. *This is italic.* This is upright again.

② With a **switch**:

This is upright. \itshape This is italic. \upshape
This is upright again.

Typestyle (3.1)

Usage:

This is upright. *This is italic.* This is upright again.

③ With a **scoped switch**:

This is upright. `{\itshape This is italic.}` This is upright again.

Typestyle (3.1)

Usage:

This is upright. *This is italic.* This is upright again.

4 With an **environment**:

```
This is upright
\begin{itshape}
  This is italic.
\end{itshape}
This is upright again.
```

Typestyle – Exercise

Exercise

Create the following text in your document:

- **This is bold and sans-serif.** (Use regular commands)
- This is upright and typewriter. (Use switches)
- THIS IS SMALL CAPS. (Use an environment)

Quotation marks (3.3)

L^AT_EX does not automatically use opening and closing quotation marks.

- ❶ For opening quotes, use ```. (backtick, accent grave)
- ❷ For closing quotes, use `'`. (apostrophe, accent aigu)
- ❸ Double them for double quotes: `` `` and `' '` (or `"`).

``Hello'` → ‘Hello’
`` `Hello' '` → “Hello”

Commenting (5)

Use the % sign to comment out text. The compiler will ignore any text that follows it on the same line.

This can be convenient if you want to:

- temporarily *leave out* some text without deleting it;
- add *comments* to your document for collaborators;
- *speed up* the compilation process;
- quickly find the source of a *bug*.

Commenting (5)

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This can be convenient if you want to:

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Note

Use Ctrl + / on Overleaf for quick commenting in and out.

Whitespace (3.5)

Note the following:

- $\text{\LaTeX}$ ignores more than one space.
- $\text{\LaTeX}$ ignores line breaks.
- $\text{\LaTeX}$ ignores tabs.

To create a new paragraph, use a blank line. For more vertical whitespace, use `\medskip`, `\bigskip`, or `\vspace` (see Section 3.5).

For horizontal whitespace, use `\quad`, `\qquad`, or `\hspace` (see Section 3.5).

Basic text formatting – Exercise

Exercise

Recreate the following text:^a

In the quiet town of WILLOWBROOK, the villagers gathered on the market square to hear the royal messenger's proclamation: *“Hear ye, hear ye, citizens! The king has decreed that all citizens must wear a hat on Mondays!”*

Rodney, the village blacksmith, started to look worried and whispered to his wife: “I don’t own a hat.”. **Eleanor**, careful not to raise attention, replied: “Well, go buy one then!”

“But it’s Sunday!” Rodney said.

^aCheck out Section 3.2 for commands to change text sizes.

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Packages

Packages are extensions to $\text{\LaTeX}$ that provide additional functionality.

Import them in your **preamble** with the `\usepackage{...}` command.

That's it! You can now use the package's **commands** and **environments** in your document.

Packages

All packages are listed on CTAN, the **Comprehensive T_EX Archive Network** (<https://ctan.org>).



The Comprehensive T_EX Archive Network

The Comprehensive T_EX Archive Network (CTAN) is the central place for all kinds of material around T_EX. CTAN has currently [6557 packages](#), [2969 contributors](#) have contributed to it. Most of the packages are free and can be downloaded and used immediately.

Packages

Almost every package
has a **documentation** file.

User Manual for glossaries.sty v4.53

Nicola L.C. Talbot
dickimaw-books.com/contact

2023-09-29

This document is also available as HTML ([glossaries-user.html](#)).

Abstract

The glossaries package provides a means to define terms or acronyms or symbols that can be referenced within your document. Sorted lists with collated locations can be generated either using $\LaTeX$ or using a supplementary indexing application. Sample documents are provided with the glossaries package. These are listed in §18.

glossaries-extra

Additional features not provided here may be available through the extension package `glossaries-extra` which, if required, needs to be installed separately. New features will be added to `glossaries-extra`. Versions of the `glossaries` package after v4.21 will mostly be just bug fixes or minor maintenance. The most significant update to the `glossaries` package since then is version 4.50, which involved the integration of `mfirstuc v2.08` and the phasing out the use of the now deprecated `textcase` package. Note that `glossaries-extra` provides an extra indexing option (`bib2gls`) which isn't available with just the base `glossaries` package.

Changing fonts (3.7)

$\text{\LaTeX}$ provides three built-in fonts:

- A main (serif) font: Computer Modern
- A sans-serif font: Computer Modern Sans
- A typewriter font: Computer Modern Typewriter

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If you need more fonts, you need to import the `fontspec` package.

```
\usepackage{fontspec}
```

Changing fonts (3.7)

L^AT_EX provides three built-in fonts:

- A main (serif) font: Computer Modern
- A sans-serif font: Computer Modern Sans
- A typewriter font: Computer Modern Typewriter

If you need more fonts, you need to import the `fontspec` package.

```
\usepackage{fontspec}
```

This requires the Xe_LL^AT_EX compiler.

Changing fonts (3.7)

Option 1: **Override** one of the default font families:

- `\setmainfont{Times New Roman}`
- `\setsansfont{Comic Sans MS}`
- `\setmonofont{Roboto Mono}`

Then use the familiar font commands (Section 3.1):

- `\textrm{...}` or `\rmfamily`
- `\textsf{...}` or `\sffamily`
- `\texttt{...}` or `\ttfamily`

Changing fonts (3.7)

Option 2: **Create** a new font family:

```
\newfontfamily{\comic}{Comic Sans MS}
```

Then use it in your document:

```
{\comic This is hilarious!}  
This is hilarious!
```

Changing fonts (3.7)

Fonts are available:

- as a **package** <https://www.tug.org/FontCatalogue/>
- **preloaded** into Overleaf URL in handout
- **installed** on your own system NB: not available on Overleaf
- **uploaded font files** to Overleaf

Changing fonts – Exercise

Exercise

- Override your default sans-serif font and set it to **Arial**.
- Create a new font family called `bettertimes` with the font Times New Roman.
- Find the ‘Gothic Textura Quadrata’ font on the TUG Font Catalogue and use it in your document.
- Bonus: try to find this jolly font among the fonts listed in the Overleaf font overview.

Tables (10)

Country	Capital	Inhabitants
Netherlands	Amsterdam	17.02 M
Germany	Berlin	82.67 M

Table: A table about two countries.

Tables (10)

```
\begin{table}[htbp]
  \centering
  \begin{tabular}{|r|c|l|}
    \hline
    Country      & Capital      & Inhabitants \\
    \hline
    Netherlands & Amsterdam    & 17.02 M      \\
    Germany     & Berlin       & 82.67 M      \\
    \hline
  \end{tabular}
  \caption{A table about two countries.}
  \label{tbltables}
\end{table}
```

Tables – Exercise

Exercise

- Recreate the table below.
- Make the table right-aligned (check the handout).
- Print a list of tables with `\listoftables`.

Name	Inaugurated
Barack Obama	2009
Donald Trump	2017
Joe Biden	2021

Table: US Presidents

References (9)

Use `\label{...}` to label a section, figure, table or footnote.

```
\subsection{Analysis}\label{ssec:analysis}
```

References (9)

Use `\ref{...}` to refer to the number, or `\pageref{...}` to refer to the page.

As we saw in Subsection `\ref{ssec:analysis}` on page `\pageref{ssec:analysis}`, the analysis is quite complex.

As we saw in Subsection 4 on page 17, the analysis is quite complex.

When you add or remove subsections, these counters are automatically updated.

Add the `hyperref` package to make your links clickable.

Document structure (6)

Command	Level
<code>\part{...}</code>	-1
<code>\chapter{...}</code>	0
<code>\section{...}</code>	1
<code>\subsection{...}</code>	2
<code>\subsubsection{...}</code>	3
<code>\paragraph{...}</code>	4
<code>\subparagraph{...}</code>	5

Table: Sectioning commands

Print a table of contents with `\tableofcontents`.

References and document structure – Exercise

Exercise

- ➊ Add a label to the Introduction section in your document.
- ➋ Create a footnote with `\footnote{...}` and label it.
- ➌ Refer to both your Introduction and your footnote in a new paragraph.
- ➍ Make sure that your references are clickable in the PDF.

Bibliography (11)

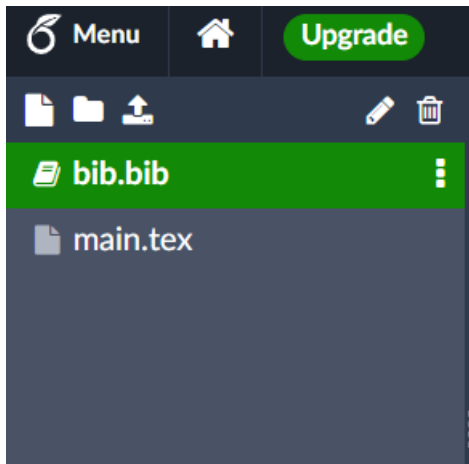
Setting up a bibliography in $\text{\LaTeX}$ requires 5 steps.

- 1 Create a `.bib` file.
- 2 Add a reference to your `.bib` file.
- 3 Import the `biblatex` package and add your `.bib` file to your preamble.
- 4 Add a citation to your document.
- 5 Print your bibliography.

We will be using `BIB $\text{\LaTeX}$` to manage our references.

Bibliography

Step one: create a .bib file.



Bibliography

Step two: add a reference to your .bib file.

```
@article{einstein1905elektro,  
  author = {Albert Einstein},  
  title = {Zur Elektrodynamik bewegter Körper},  
  journal = {Annalen der Physik},  
  year = {1905},  
  volume = {322},  
  number = {10},  
  pages = {891--921},  
  doi = {10.1002/andp.19053221004}  
}
```

Tip 1: use Google Scholar to find BIB_TE_X references.

Tip 2: check the BIB_LA_TE_X package documentation for an overview of all fields.

Bibliography

Step three: import the biblatex package and add your .bib file to your preamble.

```
\usepackage[style=apa,backend=biber]{biblatex}  
\addbibresource{bib.bib}
```

Note

- The `style` option specifies the citation style. You can find a list of all available styles in the `BIBLATEX` package documentation.
- The `backend` option specifies the backend to use for processing the bibliography. `biber` is recommended.

Bibliography

Step four: add a citation to your document.

Structure:

```
\cite[ pagenumbers ]{ citationkey }
```

Command	Result
<code>\cite[20]{einstein1905elektro}</code>	Einstein, 1905, p. 20
<code>\parencite[20]{einstein1905elektro}</code>	(Einstein, 1905, p. 20)
<code>\footcite[20]{einstein1905elektro}</code>	¹
<code>\textcite[20]{einstein1905elektro}</code>	Einstein (1905, p. 20)

Table: Citing commands

¹Einstein, 1905, p. 20

Bibliography

Step 5: print your bibliography.

```
\printbibliography
```



Einstein, A. (1905). Zur Elektrodynamik bewegter Körper. *Annalen der Physik*, 322(10), 891–921.

<https://doi.org/10.1002/andp.19053221004>

Bibliography – Exercise

Exercise

- Go to Google Scholar and find a paper you wrote or one that you particular like.
- Export a BIBTEX reference and place it in your .bib file. (It might need to be cleaned up a bit.)
- Reference it in your text. Make sure it shows up in your bibliography.
- Now switch to the authoryear citing style.
- Bonus: use `\citeyear{...}`, `\citetitle{...}` and `\citeauthor{...}` to refer to the year, title and author of the paper, respectively.

If you have imported the `hyperref` package before, note that your references are now clickable!

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Use cases

But there is a lot more you can do with $\text{\LaTeX}$.

Especially with the help of user-contributed packages.

Use cases

But there is a lot more you can do with $\text{\LaTeX}$.



Figure: Musical notation (`musixtex`)

Use cases

But there is a lot more you can do with $\text{\LaTeX}$.

(6) *k- wapm -a -s'i -m -wapunin -uk*
 Cl V Agr Neg Agr Tns Agr
 2 see 3ACC 2PL preterit 3PL
 'you (pl) didn't see them'

Figure: Glossed and automatically numbered sentences (expex)

Use cases

But there is a lot more you can do with $\text{\LaTeX}$.



Dubois
10... h×g3!!



Dubois
14... ×f3

□ Dubois	London 1862
■ Steinitz	Giucco Pianissimo – C50

1. e4 e5 2. ♘f3 ♘c6 3. ♙c4 ♙c5 4. d3 ♘f6 5. ♙g5?!
[5. ♘c3] 5...d6 6. 0-0?! h6 7. ♙h4 g5 8. ♙g3 h5! 9. ♘×g5
h4! 10. ♘×f7 h×g3!! (D) 11. ♘×d8 [11. ♘×h8 ♖e7! ♠♖h7 12. ♘f7
♙×f2+ 13. ♚×f2 g×f2+ 14. ♙×f2 ♘g4+ 15. ♙g3 ♖f6 16. ♖f3 ♖g7-+]
11... ♙g4 12. ♖e1 ♘d4 13. ♘c3□ [13. h3 ♘e2+ 14. ♙h1 ♚×h3+
15. g×h3♙f3#] 13... ♘f3+! 14. g×f3 ♙×f3 (D) 0:1

Figure: Chess notation diagrams (skak and texmate)

Use cases

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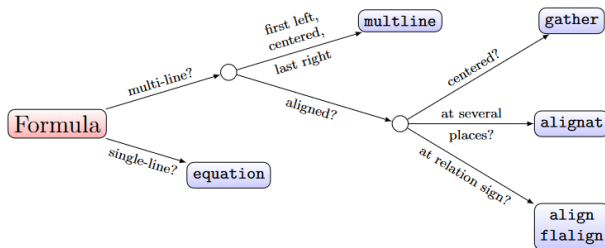


Figure: Graphs (tikz)

Use cases

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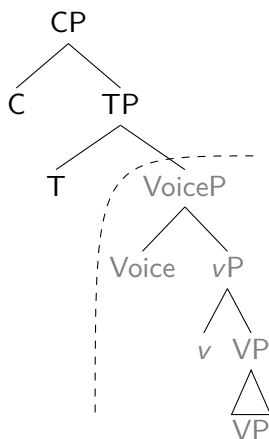


Figure: Syntax trees (forest)

Use cases

But there is a lot more you can do with L^AT_EX.

Le premier liure de Moyse, Di^ct Genef^e.



A R G V M E N T .

Ce premier liure comprend l'origine & causes de toutes choses, principalement la creation de l'homme, qu'il a esté du commencement, fa cheute & releuement : comment d'un tous ont esté procréés, & pour leurs enormes pechés Dieu les a consumés, par le deluge, referué huit, dont la semence a rempli toute la terre. Puis il descrit les vies, faicts, religion, & lignees des saints Patriarches, qui ont resçu deuant la Loy : Les benedictions, promesses, & alliances du Seigneur faictes avec iceux : Comment de le la terre de Chanaan sont descendus en Egypte. Aucuns ont appellé ce liure, le liure des Iustes. Toutefois ceci a obtenu entre nos predecesseurs & nous, qu'il est appelé Genef^e, qui est vn mot Grec, signifiant generation & origine : d'autant qu'en icelui est desrite l'origine & procreation de toutes choses : & nommément des Peres anciens, qui ont esté tant deuant qu'après le deluge, & eu esgard à IESVS CHRIST descen-
du d'iceux selon la chair.

C H A P I T R E I .

¹ Creation du ciel & de la terre, II, 20. & de tout ce qui y est compris. 3-14 De la lumiere aussi, 26 & de l'homme, 28 *Auquel tout est assubietti.* 2-2. 28 Dieu benit toutes ses œures, 31 qu'il a accomplis en six iours.



¹Ieu ²crea
^bau com
mence -
ment ^cle

les eaux, qui estoient sous l'estendue, d'auec celles, qui estoient sur l'estendue. Et fut ainsi faict.

8 Et Dieu appela l'estendue, Ciel. Lors fut faict le soir & le matin du second iour.

9 ¶ Puis Dieu di^t, ⁴Que les eaux, qui sont sous le ciel, foyent assemblees en

I Ce premier chapitre est fort difficile : & pour cette cause, il estoit defendu entre les Hebreux de le lire & interpreter deuant l'âge de trente ans.

a Fit de rien, & sans aucune matiere.

¹ Job 38.4, Psa. 33.6, & 89.12., 135.5, Ecclesiasti. 13.4, *Alc* 14-15, & 17.14

b Tout premierement, & auit qu'il y eut aucune creature, *Iohan* 1.10.

² Hebr. 11.3.
c Le ciel & la terre, les eaux, les abysses, le pre-

pourquoy les Hebreux comencent le iour apres le soleil couchant.

g Ce mot d'Est^e due, compréd tout ce qui se voit par dessus nous, tit en la region celeste, qu'elementaire.

⁴ Psa. 33.7.

h Il est ici parlé de deux manieres d'eaux : asqueroit, celles q sont sous l'estendue, comme la mer, les fleues, & autres qui sont sur la terre & celles, qui sont sur

Use cases

But there is a lot more you can do with $\text{\LaTeX}$, also for non-academic purposes.

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① Curricula vitae

Use cases

But there is a lot more you can do with $\text{\LaTeX}$, also for non-academic purposes.

- 1 Curricula vitae
- 2 Letters

Use cases

But there is a lot more you can do with $\text{\LaTeX}$, also for non-academic purposes.

- 1 Curricula vitae
- 2 Letters
- 3 PowerPoint-like presentations

Use cases

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- 1 Curricula vitae
- 2 Letters
- 3 PowerPoint-like presentations
- 4 Business cards

Use cases

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- 1 Curricula vitae
- 2 Letters
- 3 PowerPoint-like presentations
- 4 Business cards
- 5 Newsletters

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- 6 Books

When (not) to use $\text{\LaTeX}$

$\text{\LaTeX}$ is not always the best tool for the job.

$\text{\LaTeX}$ is great for:

$\text{\LaTeX}$ may not be ideal for:

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- scientific documents (articles, theses, books);
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- documents with complex typesetting requirements;

$\text{\LaTeX}$ may not be ideal for:

- quick, private notes;
- presentations (beamer);
- posters, flyers and other graphical documents;

Troubleshooting

If you do not know how to do something in $\text{\LaTeX}$, you are mostly likely not alone.

Useful resources:

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- Visit the Digital Humanities **walk-in hours** (this room, Thursdays, 14:00–15:00)

AI and L^AT_EX

LLMs (like ChatGPT) have become very good at dealing with L^AT_EX code.

They can help you:

- Explain existing code/commands.



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What does "LaTeX Error: Not allowed in LR mode." mean?

In LaTeX, "Not allowed in LR mode" means you used a command that requires a different kind of layout context while LaTeX is currently in LR mode ("left-to-right mode").

Most often, this happens when you put a **paragraph-level command or environment** inside something that expects a **single line of content**.

Common example

For instance, this can cause the error:

```
\mbox{
  This is some text.

  And this is a new paragraph.
}
```

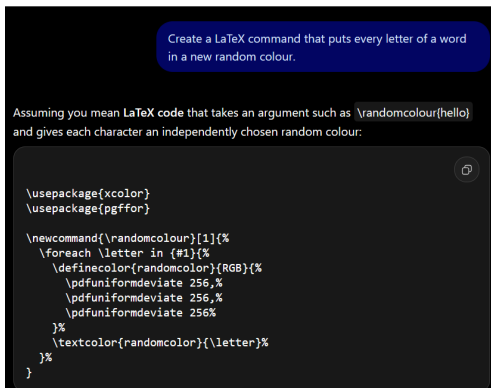
`\mbox{...}` operates in LR mode, where LaTeX is building one horizontal line. A paragraph break isn't allowed there.

AI and L^AT_EX

LLMs (like ChatGPT) have become very good at dealing with L^AT_EX code.

They can help you:

- Explain existing code/commands.
- Explain error messages.
- Generate L^AT_EX code.



L^AT_EX and AI – Exercise

Exercise

- Ask an LLM to generate a piece of L^AT_EX code for you, e.g.
 - ① Give me a table with alternating row colours: even rows should be light gray, odd rows should be white.
 - ② Add a line plot to a document with the following data: (1,2), (2,3), (3,5), (4,7), (5,11).
 - ③ Give musical notation for the opening bar of Beethoven's 5th Symphony.
- Does the generated code work? If it doesn't, can you fix it using additional prompts?
- How can LLMs be helpful in your work with L^AT_EX?
- What are the risks of using LLMs in your work with L^AT_EX?

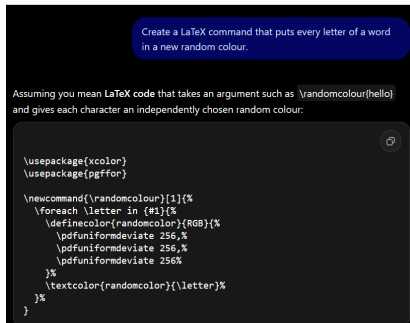
L^AT_EX and AI

Caveats:

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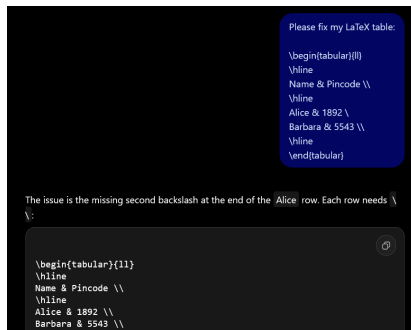
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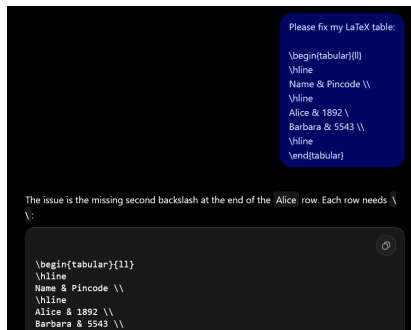
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L^AT_EX and AI

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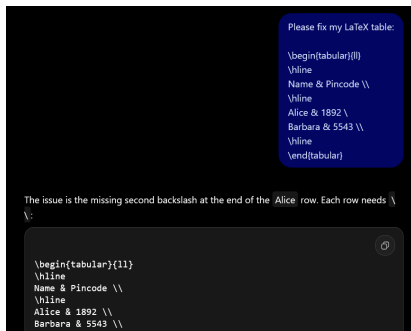
- Inaccurate or incorrect output.
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L^AT_EX and AI

Caveats:

- Inaccurate or incorrect output.
- Unclear data policies
- Obstruction to learning
- Environmental impact



Where to go from here

$\text{\LaTeX}$ is a skill that needs practice to master.

But it is a valuable tool for your academic and post-academic career.

- Rewrite an existing chapter/paper into $\text{\LaTeX}$.
- Write new non-urgent documents in $\text{\LaTeX}$.
- For new manuscripts: check with the editors first!

Thank you!

Thank you for your attention.

$\text{\LaTeX}$ source code and slides are available on
<https://github.com/CentreForDigitalHumanities/latex-workshop>.

Happy $\text{\LaTeX}$ ing!